
GenAI and Academic Integrity: Redefining the Role of Writing Centres in a Shifting Digital Landscape

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This article investigates the transformative effects of generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) on Academic Integrity and the role of writing centres (WCs) in post-secondary institutions. By exploring the scientific, philosophical, and educational perspectives on the current development of GenAI in academia, the article highlights the opportunities for WC administrators and staff to embrace change. Suggestions include becoming familiar with new discourse communities, cultivating new relationships with colleagues, redefining WC pedagogy and culture, incorporating new digital literacies into training, engaging in the ongoing development and update of academic integrity policies, and developing new support networks across WCs. The objective of this article is to offer insights into how WCs can adapt to this new landscape and ensure their continued relevance within the larger educational ecosystem.

Keywords: writing centres, GenAI, tutoring, academic integrity, post-secondary education, digital literacies, educational policies, discourse communities, ethics in AI and education, academic support networks

Writing is my way of reaffirming my own existence.

—Gao Xingjian, 2021, Chinese dissident

INTRODUCTION

In late December 2022, when Stephen Marche's article was published, about a new artificial intelligence (AI) program called ChatGPT that had just been launched on the internet, the author of this article felt a sense of

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dread and powerlessness fall on her. As the director of a writing centre (WC), she immediately saw the demise of WCs and the end of her career.

Since that moment, she has spent countless hours learning about generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) and trying to find a place for her WC in this new world. She understood that she could look at things from three different perspectives: first, the scientific perspective (What are large language models?); second, the philosophical perspective (Is GenAI an ethical or unethical tool?); and third, the educational perspective (What does academic integrity mean in a GenAI world?).

She was not a computer scientist nor a philosopher, but she decided to investigate these three perspectives from her own unique position as a WC director and then offer some practical suggestions for WC directors. But first, she briefly discusses the history of WCs and academic integrity in post-secondary institutions. This provides a context in which new developments in technology, ethics, and pedagogy can be discussed.

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

The reason this article focuses on the roles and responsibilities of WCs, in parallel to the development of academic integrity over the years, is because WCs have always had a complicated relationship with plagiarism and academic integrity. On one hand, WCs provide a safe environment for students to understand how to properly incorporate secondary sources into their work. On the other hand, WCs have consistently resisted being seen as ‘plagiarism police’, despite expectations and sometimes fear from some students and professors (Salem, 2016). Now, with the introduction of GenAI, the relationship between writing, WCs, technology, and issues of plagiarism is becoming even more complicated. It seemed important to emphasise this relationship, because the role of WCs will become increasingly important as these issues become more complex.

Historical Developments of Writing Centre Roles and Responsibilities

Shaped by the changing needs of students, political and economic ups and downs, and the fluctuating institutional and pedagogical positioning of the importance of writing and communication, WCs have historically adapted their missions and services to accommodate the changing academic landscape in many significant aspects. In 1990, Elliott defined the role of WC as supporting composition and literature classes, conducting,

and staying current with research, educating peer tutors, and establishing their centres as credible academic support. A few years later, [Harris \(2000\)](#) highlighted the importance of the partnership between WCs and Writing Across the Curriculum (WAC) and the role of WCs in supporting WAC programs. By 2013, McKinney argued that WCs should grow beyond the traditional view of being mere spaces for one-on-one peer tutoring and re-envision the boundaries of their work and how they are perceived by their educational community as a whole. Later, in 2019, Greenfield encouraged WCs to move away from political neutrality towards a more committed stance on social justice. In 2021, Giaimo (2021) highlighted the need to address new challenges faced by WC directors and tutors during the COVID-19 pandemic, including decreased engagement and motivation, while also exposing long-standing precarities in higher education like mental health concerns, homelessness, and food insecurity among students and sometimes tutors, too.

Alongside these pedagogical and philosophical changes, WCs have increasingly embraced and championed technology and digital literacy ([Lee & Carpenter, 2014](#)), reflecting a broader academic trend towards digital integration. This transition also responds to the growing prevalence of technology in all aspects of communication and research, as well as to the COVID-19 pandemic, which necessitated a rapid transition to online teaching, tutoring, and learning. To be sure, the integration of various technologies, including editing software, online tutoring platforms, multimodal composing tools, assistive technologies (such as text-to-speech and word-prediction software), and GenAI, has empowered WC tutors and student writers by giving them more choices in how to communicate ideas. These tools have also transformed the dynamics of writing instruction and support, increasing students' control over their options and choices. This pivotal shift in technology has highlighted the importance of continual improvement and adaptation in educational practices and has been crucial in preparing students to navigate and contribute to an increasingly digital world.

Historical Developments of Academic Integrity¹ Challenges and Their Impact

The historical developments of academic integrity issues in post-secondary education, along with the creation of related regulations and policies, have

seen a significant evolution over time. The rise of academic honour codes from the mid-1980s until the early 2000s reflected a growing emphasis on academic integrity in higher education institutions (Parnter, 2020), particularly in Canada and the United States. This period also saw an increase in academic integrity education initiatives and the development of student support services (Parnter, 2020) to address the various needs arising from an increase in student diversity. Systematic inquiry into academic integrity in Canada and the United States also started in the 1990s, setting the stage for a proliferation of work in the field (Eaton & Christensen Hughes, 2022). Over these years, as violations of academic integrity have become more frequent and complex (Baron 2022), there has also been a noticeable shift in the perception of academic honesty and dishonesty among WCs, students, faculty, and administrators alike, from the earlier accusations and perception of ‘corrupt conduct’ to the more recent perspectives of prevention and ‘teaching opportunities.’

The evolution of academic integrity policies and practices has always been influenced by technological advancements. The internet, CliffsNotes, Wikipedia, SparkNotes, cell phones, paper mills, impersonations, contract cheating (Miron et al., 2021), and many other resources and schemes have led to the need for post-secondary education institutions to revisit their policies and practices, to enhance academic integrity resources and support, and to develop plagiarism detection tools such as Ephorus, Plagiarism Scanner, and Turnitin (Baron, 2023). The challenges related to breaches in student academic integrity have also led to a focus on aligning concepts of academic integrity, policies, and processes with evolving teaching and learning practices (Sbaffi & Zhao, 2022), including WC work.

With the advent of GenAI tools, however, academic integrity policies have entered a new era. These new tools use technologies and information sources whose origins and ethical collection are not transparently disclosed, which will require a thorough reevaluation and update of the conventional *academic integrity* definition. As noted earlier, WCs are already in a complicated position in relation to plagiarism and academic integrity (Pelzer, 2019), which makes them ready to play a key role. They are well-suited to assist students in understanding and navigating the ethical use of GenAI tools, while also fostering critical thinking and original writing skills.

The following three sections address how WC experts can become key players in terms of educating faculty and students about the technical

aspects of GenAI, developing and enforcing academic integrity practices and regulations, and preserving the integrity and value of writing in higher education.

TECHNICAL

During an April 2024 meeting of the GenAI Committee (established by the author at the Royal Military College), committee members pointed out a general apathy among faculty members: overwhelmed by the technical and practical complexities of GenAI, many of our colleagues choose to simply ignore it and persist with their usual teaching styles. At the same time, WCs worldwide are actively exploring ways to integrate AI into their support for student writing and digital literacy while remaining committed to staying true to their core educational philosophies and traditional practices (Center for Writing Excellence, 2023; Deans et al., 2023).

Few people had extensive knowledge about AI before ChatGPT came out or were well versed in technical language and the complexities of Large Language Models. It is our responsibility, as WC directors, however, to understand basic concepts and theories of GenAI so that we can explain them to our tutors, our students, our faculty members, and our university administrators. The following are some basic concepts and how they can be used by WCs.

Basic Info About Large Language Models and GenAI

One fundamental principle about GenAI is the concept of large language models (LLMs): massive data sets, be they text or images, are fed by researchers into a computer system. This system is subsequently trained on understanding the composition of words, sentences, or visual elements, thanks to an architecture known as a Transformer, which then enables the generation of different types of content. This content, however, is rapidly becoming indistinguishable from human-created writing and visual art. This latest (and, many say, unfortunate) advancement is largely attributable to new and sophisticated AI tools (like undetectable.ai) that refine GenAI-generated content to sound or appear more convincingly human.

Among these tools are various writing support programs, such as Writetfull (writetfull.com) and QuillBot (quillbot.com), which assist in drafting and refining text. Others, like AudioPen (audiopen.ai), specialise in speech transcription, while platforms like Claude (claude.ai) can synthesise

and summarise vast amounts of articles. Student-oriented tools, such as Jungle (wisdolia.com) and Kortext (kortext.com), offer study and review aids, whereas Beautiful (beautiful.ai) and Gamma (gamma.app) assist in crafting visually appealing presentation slides. Furthermore, platforms like Elicit (elicit.com), ResearchRabbit (researchrabbit.ai), and Scite_ (scite.ai) streamline the process of searching and organising academic references. For professors in all academic fields, tools like <https://maestra.ai/tools/live-transcription> offer real-time lecture transcription and translation, enhancing accessibility for international students, while <https://academia.stackexchange.com/> provides a platform for academic collaboration and research management. These GenAI tools (and many, many more) collectively demonstrate the extensive range and potential of GenAI in enhancing teaching, learning, and research. Some of them are free, some require a fee for premium services, and most are accessible around the world and in multiple languages.

These multiple GenAI tools are powerful and can enhance and support all aspects of the writing process. However, the ease and efficiency with which GenAI writing tools can write entire papers and provide comprehensive writing assistance pose a significant challenge to traditional WCs. The round-the-clock availability of these tools means students can receive immediate and tailored writing support whenever needed, diminishing the appeal of visiting WCs during business hours. Additionally, GenAI's seemingly amazing capabilities in providing instant feedback, grammar corrections, and stylistic suggestions, although not necessarily as useful and pedagogically sound as students believe them to be (Baron, 2023), might be perceived as superior to the time-consuming and effort-intensive traditional procedures used in WCs. These perceptions threaten to render WCs obsolete unless directors and tutors adapt to this new GenAI reality.

WCs' Role and Digital Literacies

Because LLMs are so closely tied to writing and communication, it stands to reason that WCs would be amongst the entities most affected by the rapid influx of new GenAI tools. In addition, the history of WCs and their relationship with digital literacy reflects an intrinsic recognition of the importance of integrating digital literacy skills into the teaching of writing. For this reason, WCs should lead the discussions and development of policies related to GenAI in post-secondary institutions.

Indeed, while the capabilities of GenAI tools expand, it's important to be aware of some of these tools' key limitations, such as their infamous "hallucinations" (Deans et al., 2023), and their easy use for spreading disinformation and misinformation (Hsu & Thompson, 2023; Tunney, 2024). The term *hallucination* refers to instances where GenAI systems generate misleading or entirely fabricated information. This phenomenon is not just a minor glitch but a significant challenge in the field of AI, stemming from limitations in the training data or the inherent biases in the algorithms. In the context of post-secondary education, the existence of these possible hallucinations necessitates the development and teaching of robust mechanisms for fact-checking and cross-referencing GenAI-generated content. Users need to learn how to integrate GenAI tools with library databases of verified information, for example, to enhance the reliability of the output. Similarly, misinformation and disinformation, which are false or censored information published specifically to deceive and manipulate the public (Tate, 2023), are also dangerous and can undermine the credibility of educational resources. To counter this, educational institutions should foster a culture of critical thinking and artificial intelligence literacy, ensuring that students can think critically and are equipped to discern and challenge dubious content. Fact-checking and cross-referencing approaches ensure that while students leverage the efficiency of GenAI, they also learn how to remain grounded in factual accuracy and develop skills in critical evaluation.

Accordingly, one of the main tasks that WCs should undertake is to incorporate new digital literacy training for tutors, as was done by the Elon University Writing Center. For example, WC tutors and directors should have serious discussions about if, when, and how they might be using GenAI when providing asynchronous feedback to students or generating ideas with students during tutorials. Also, WC should develop and offer educational tools for students and faculty on critical digital literacy and 'AI-mediated communication' (Hancock et al., 2020). The *Cambridge Life Competencies Framework* (2018), for example, explains that digital literacy needs to be taught more systematically in post-secondary institutions, as it provides students with the foundational skills necessary for their effective participation in society and for fulfilling their potential throughout education and careers. WC experts need to take the lead and emphasise the importance of digital literacy discussions, workshops,

classroom presentations, and even courses for students and faculty, systematically promoted by department heads and deans, focusing systematically on explaining the different GenAI tools that are available and how to use them effectively and safely, and encouraging a critical evaluation of GenAI's outputs.

Writing centres, as places of multidisciplinary learning and teaching, are exceptionally qualified to collaborate with various departments and faculty members to study different disciplines' different uses of GenAI, the impact of GenAI tools on different academic fields, and the influence of GenAI on WC tutoring, writing instruction, and faculty research. Indeed, GenAI's iterative ability, that is, tuning responses based on previous inputs, makes it an invaluable tool for WCs in helping students develop initial drafts or ideas for their research papers. Similarly, WCs can teach students (through workshops, class presentations, pamphlets, etc.) effective prompt writing skills (a technique also known as 'prompt engineering'), emphasising the art of asking smart 'machine question' to get the best 'machine result,' to harness the full potential of the new GenAI tools (Deans et al., 2023), as the mastery of crafting effective prompts is quickly growing, and word choice and the exact formulation of requests can greatly influence the output of LLMs.

PHILOSOPHICAL

Throughout history, writers have always sought easier ways to work, from the printing press to typewriters, computers, and now autocomplete and predictive text features (Baron, 2023). It is no surprise, then, that students, and even WC directors, are eager to use GenAI. However, teaching our students, first, about some of GenAI's dirty secrets and, second, about the problematic use of GenAI tools in the classroom is crucial. Fortunately, once again, WCs can play a key role in ensuring that these ethical aspects of GenAI are highlighted and responsible practices are enforced.

Ethical Considerations and Academic Integrity

The advancement of GenAI technologies is mired in a variety of ethical and practical challenges. Intellectual property concerns are at the forefront, with GenAI systems often relying on extensive human-created content databases, leading to debates over the originality and potential infringement of AI outputs on creators' rights (Appel et al., 2023).

Companies such as OpenAI, Midjourney, Microsoft, Stability AI, Meta, and GitHub are currently being sued by newspapers, writers, authors, and artists for violating copyright laws (Knight, 2023; Marcus & Southen, 2023; Moreno, 2023; Schrader, 2023), and many more lawsuits on copyright infringements by GenAI firms are expected to take place in the future. The propagation of bias and toxicity is another pressing issue: because these systems are trained on existing data sets, they can inadvertently reproduce societal biases on race, gender, and religion, resulting in outputs that could be discriminatory (Abid et al., 2021; Ngo & Sakhaee, 2022). The environmental impact of GenAI is also significant, as the energy-intensive nature of training and operating LLMs contributes to ecological issues (Heikkilä, 2023). This ties into broader concerns about the tech industry's environmental footprint, as the hardware for GenAI systems requires rare minerals and components (Pratt, 2023). Additionally, there is concern over the exploitation of 'digital slaves,' like Kenyan labourers paid very little to remove toxic and dangerous content from LLMs (Perrigo, 2023). These negative aspects of GenAI (and many more) highlight the crucial need for users to remain aware of the impact of their choices when selecting and using these tools.

But one of the most significant concerns with GenAI in the academic context is, of course, plagiarism. The proliferation of GenAI tools has simplified tasks such as essay writing, homework completion, and finding exam answers. Initially, following the release of ChatGPT, the generated content was easily identifiable due to its tendency to hallucinate, a lack of knowledge about current events, fabricated references, and a formulaic, unengaging writing style. 'GenAI detectors,' such as GPTZero and Turnitin's own GenAI detector, were then developed very quickly, basing their results on the measurement of what is called 'perplexity' and 'burstiness,' that is, the randomness and variability of human writing versus the statistical probability and predictability of machine writing (Warner, 2023). However, the advent of advanced GenAI tools has enabled the transformation of GenAI-generated content into more human-like writing, significantly diminishing the effectiveness of these detectors (Weber-Wulff et al., 2023). This evolution has led to a rise in undetected cheating among resourceful students, as well as erroneously accused students (Krause et al., 2024).

WCs' Role and Policies

WC experts can have a positive influence on two fronts when it comes to writing and academic integrity policies: first, with students and, second, with the institution as a whole.

First, WC directors and tutors need to rethink their pedagogy and culture. This means considering how to remain faithful to traditional philosophies and practices while addressing the varied requirements of faculty members and students' growing desire to complete their work more easily. For example, when working with students, WC tutors can ask them about the value of creativity and individuality, their perception of pride in one's work, their definitions of ownership and copyrights, and the different ways they might want to cite GenAI-generated (or 'augmented') content. Tutors can also address students' potential over-reliance on LLMs (Baron, 2023), their unquestioning trust in technology, and the neglect of individual voice, personal choice, intellectual curiosity, the purpose of learning, and self-awareness (Crouse, 2022). Ultimately, WC tutors play a crucial role in helping students navigate these evolving ethical challenges in academic writing, understand and adhere to their professors' instructions, and think critically about if and how they want to use GenAI tools.

Second, with the institution as a whole, WCs must lead discussions (e.g., through workshops, newsletters, visits to department meetings, orientations for new faculty members, collaboration with the Teaching and Learning Office and the Academic Integrity Office) about the traditional definitions of plagiarism and academic honesty, as well as about the rapidly evolving concept of ownership. For example, the current legal framework suggests that users of GenAI, who submit content generated by these models, may be held legally responsible if the information is false and defamatory (Calvert, 2023). Users are considered as 'publishers,' even though they did not create the content themselves. Moreover, failing to independently verify the generated content's accuracy can constitute negligence (Calvert, 2023). Accordingly, some professors and institutions have delineated clear restrictions and conditions to abide by when using GenAI tools (Spannagel, 2023), stating clearly that students are solely and entirely responsible for the work they submit. WCs can help faculty members articulate such rules for their courses and discuss their reasons and beliefs with their students (as was done at Elon University and the University of California Davis). WC experts should also encourage and

participate actively in the development of institutional policies regarding the use of GenAI and the definitions of academic integrity and academic misconduct by joining academic integrity committees, for example, or offering to lead a committee on the revision of academic regulations.

EDUCATIONAL

Making suggestions based on the current situation is difficult when the development of GenAI tools is so rapid and unpredictable. However, certain questions and principles will likely always remain at the forefront of all discussions related to academic writing and the purpose and mission of WCs.

GenAI and Academic Writing

In her 2023 book, Baron offers an in-depth analysis of ‘the lure of efficiency’ on writing since the Gutenberg press, from classical composition classes to spell checkers to modern tools like ChatGPT. She urges writers of all trades (academic writers, creative writers, lawyers, journalists, teachers, students, translators, editors, etc.) to ask themselves about the purpose and value of writing, both by hand and on computers, warns against the seductive ease of GenAI, and emphasises the importance of retaining our individual voices and writing skills as tools for personal introspection, critical thinking, and unique expression. Ultimately, she encourages thoughtful and balanced decisions about collaborating with GenAI, ensuring that technology enhances the cognitive and social benefits of literacy and does not compromise our writing and critical thinking skills.

Looking at GenAI from a more prosaic perspective, [Mollick \(2023\)](#), in his acclaimed blog post, ‘Centaur and Cyborgs on the Jagged Frontier,’ presents two types of users of GenAI tools: on one hand, Centaurs use a clear division of labour between human and machine, strategically allocating tasks based on strengths. Cyborgs, on the other hand, integrate human and machine work more closely, intertwining their own work and thinking with GenAI. He emphasises how these two different approaches to using GenAI will yield different outcomes and highlights the importance of understanding GenAI’s capabilities and limitations so as to use it to its fullest capacity while avoiding its pitfalls.

Many creative writing, composition, and literature teachers worldwide are mourning the days when GenAI did not exist. Nonetheless, the

disciplines of writing studies, composition, and rhetoric had already been undergoing transformative shifts well before the emergence of GenAI. In their book *Bad Ideas About Writing*, for example, [Ball and Loewe \(2017\)](#) compiled several chapters from different writing studies experts critiquing numerous ‘bad ideas,’ long-standing misconceptions, and poor practices that have plagued the teaching of writing for decades: the five-paragraph essay, rules about the passive voice, the assumed transfer of critical thinking skills, the thesis statement, the importance of planning, the use of rubrics, and so on. So, while the arrival of GenAI might have come as an unwelcome surprise to many writing-centric educators, [Baron \(2023\)](#) suggests that such a development could have been anticipated. Given these already happening shifts in writing and composition courses as well as the evolution of technology, teachers and writers alike, Baron argues, should be able to adapt to these new developments. Writing centres, should, too.

WCs’ Role and Community Building

Writing centres, since their very creation, have consistently been pulled in various directions and have adapted to multiple layers of complexity. Shifts in pedagogical approaches within composition and writing studies, technological developments, political tugs of war in administration and personal preferences, fluctuations in budgetary allocations, and common misconceptions about the roles and responsibilities of WCs have all made them highly adaptable and willing to explore new methods and practices. Indeed, the distinctive institutional and pedagogical positioning of WCs has been highlighted over the years, making them particularly well-suited for community engagement within the larger college or university. As such, WCs have always sought allies across campus, collaborating with various programs, departments, and faculties in increasingly innovative ways to continuously re-establish their importance and showcase their versatility. It is thus no surprise that WCs are uniquely positioned and likely the most well-equipped campus unit to lead initiatives related to the use of GenAI tools, providing expert guidance to students, professors, and administrators alike in all matters of writing and academic integrity in this new GenAI era.

In addition to the various initiatives outlined in previous sections, WC directors also have the opportunity to either form networks or work

more closely with scientists and colleagues in all disciplines who use GenAI regularly (e.g., political science colleagues working on AI-enabled surveillance and profiling) to exchange knowledge and explore innovative applications of GenAI. They can also continue to emphasise the shift towards authentic assessment, where GenAI can aid in crafting complex, real-world tasks. Furthermore, WCs can collaborate with graduate programmes and faculty to develop strategies, tools, and policies for thesis and dissertation writing (like what the University of Toronto has done), as well as for the research process. This collaboration can include discussions about which human skills are essential to nurture and which computer skills are critical for graduate students to succeed both academically and in their future careers.

Beyond their own institutions, WCs should strive to build robust communities of practice by forming networks and partnerships with other WCs. These collaborations can facilitate joint research projects and initiatives that advance the field, as well as the sharing of experiences, resources, and best practices regarding GenAI integration and academic integrity policies. Engaging in such collaborative efforts can also enhance the prestige of WCs. For instance, upon learning about GenAI, the author reached out to fellow WC directors in military academies and the Graduate Writing Center Consortium. Together, they started sharing interesting facts they were learning, documents we were crafting, new policies we tried implementing, cool presentations we were attending, and government policies they had to follow. They also developed a series of workshops which were offered to all faculty members at our institutions. Most importantly, this network provided a safe and supportive space for them to share their frustrations, challenges, and even moments of laughter and commiseration as they navigated this new world together. Administrators in the author's institution were also pleased to learn that internal decisions regarding GenAI were in concordance with the actions taken by comparable institutions. A few months later, the author was invited to join an international research initiative, collaborating with thirty-three other universities across North America and Europe. Their investigation focuses on the interplay between writing, academic integrity, and technology. This prestigious Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council (SSHRC)-funded project and the author's collaborative efforts demonstrated to her institution that WC experts are pivotal in addressing these issues and that

they are essential in fostering engagement within the campus community *and* the international scholarly community.

CONSEQUENCES OF RESISTANCE TO CHANGE AND CONCLUSION

The concept of “human in the loop” is used in various research areas, including weapons development and GenAI. In the context of AI and machine learning, this concept involves incorporating human input into the training and evaluation of AI models and their outputs. It underscores the importance of human-machine collaboration to enhance human capabilities with AI rather than replacing human intelligence entirely (Baron, 2023, p. 178). In September 2023, Hennessy’s interviewees emphasised that AI will not replace all workers, but those who fail to use AI tools effectively may be replaced by those who can. This highlights a crucial role for educators and WCs: to not dismiss GenAI as a mere nuisance but to educate students in expertly using GenAI and AI tools. Likewise, educators have the responsibility of preparing students to be continuous learners, staying abreast of new developments in GenAI, and following institutional and governmental guidance (such as the recommendations by the [Government of Canada, 2024](#)).

As for WCs, to remain relevant, they must make themselves indispensable by participating in the ‘reinvention’ effort, integrating GenAI tools into the writing process, focusing on areas where human interaction and insight are crucial, and keeping in mind the ‘human-in-the-loop’ concept, that is, the nuanced understanding and personalised guidance of human tutors are irreplaceable, as we learned recently. Indeed, while online learning and the enhanced use of technology were necessary during the COVID-19 pandemic, students tended to prefer and perform better in-person learning experiences (Price Banks & Vergez, 2022). This adaptation will position WCs not as competitors to, or victims of GenAI but as complementary resources that leverage the best of both technology and human expertise. Not adapting to the changing landscape would result in several setbacks. These include falling behind in educational trends, writing instruction, academic integrity policies, and technology usage. Not adapting would also hinder the reinforcement of WCs’ perceived value within the institution and impede the adoption of new technologies and pedagogical approaches. Additionally, it could affect the creation of ethical instructional practices and technologies in our individual contexts.

This failure to adapt could also compromise institutions' competitive edge in terms of student success and outcomes. Finally, it might limit their ability to embrace progressive approaches in education and research, as well as the institution's capacity to secure funding, grants, and partnerships for innovative projects.

In 1942, Isaac Asimov (1950) formulated his famous Three Laws of Robotics, designed to protect humans from physical harm by robots. In 2018, Pasquale introduced new rules that emphasise the importance of collaboration between humans and machines. These include principles such as 'Robotic systems and AI should complement professions, not replace them.' As WC directors, feeling both anxious and excited about what these future collaborations with technology will bring us is normal, and it is hoped that the scientists currently developing GenAI tools will bear these new principles in mind and that WCs will continue to thrive.

Machine should work. People should think.

—IBM, 1967

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NOTE

1. The term *academic integrity* is used here to mean 'behaviors that courageously uphold honesty, fairness, responsibility, trustworthiness, and respect in academics' (Bertram Gallant & Rettinger, 2022, p. 2).

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